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BASICSTAR WORD PROCESSOR - User Manual

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BasicStar is a full-screen plain-text word processor written in QB64-PE.
It runs in an 80-column by 25-line text-mode screen.
It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or connected to the owners of the WordStar trademark.

THE SCREEN

Rows 1-21 Editing area. Your document is displayed here.
Row 22 Status bar. Shows filename, line/column, and WRAP indicator.
Row 23 Shortcut bar (editing commands).
Row 24 Shortcut bar (find and replace commands).
Row 25 Message line. Prompts and status messages appear here.

NAVIGATION

Arrow keys Move the cursor one character or line at a time.
Home Move to the start of the current line.
End Move to the end of the current line.
Page Up Scroll up one screenful.
Page Down Scroll down one screenful.

The document scrolls automatically when the cursor moves off the top or bottom of the editing area.

EDITING

Type any character Insert it at the cursor position.
Enter Insert a new line, splitting the current line.
Backspace Delete the character to the left of the cursor.
At the start of a line, joins the line to the one above.
Delete Delete the character under the cursor.
At the end of a line, joins the next line to this one.

The status bar shows an asterisk (*) after the filename whenever the
document has unsaved changes.

SELECTING TEXT

Hold Shift while pressing any arrow key to select text. The selected
region is highlighted in reverse video.

Shift+Left / Right Extend selection one character at a time.
Shift+Up / Down Extend selection one line at a time.

Pressing Escape clears the selection without deleting anything.

Typing any character, pressing Enter, Backspace, or Delete while a
selection is active will delete the selection first.

CUT, COPY AND PASTE

Ctrl+C Copy the selected text to the clipboard.
Ctrl+X Cut the selected text (copy then delete).
Ctrl+V Paste the clipboard contents at the cursor position.

The clipboard holds plain text. Newlines within the pasted text create
new lines in the document. The clipboard is internal to BasicStar and
is not shared with the operating system clipboard.

UNDO AND REDO

Ctrl+Z Undo the last edit.
Ctrl+Y Redo the last undone edit.

BasicStar keeps up to 30 levels of undo history. The history is cleared
when you open or create a new document.

FIND AND REPLACE

Ctrl+F Find.
You will be prompted to enter a search term. BasicStar
searches forward from the cursor, wrapping round to the top
of the document if necessary. The search is case-insensitive.
Press Esc at the prompt to cancel.

Ctrl+G Find Next.
Repeat the last search from the current cursor position.
No prompt is shown.

Ctrl+R Replace All.
You will be prompted for a search term and then a replacement.
Every occurrence in the document is replaced in one operation.
The replacement is undoable with a single Ctrl+Z.
Press Esc at either prompt to cancel.

At the Find prompt, pressing Enter without typing anything repeats the
last search term.

WORD WRAP

Ctrl+W Toggle word wrap on or off.

When word wrap is ON, BasicStar inserts a hard line break automatically when a word would extend beyond column 79. The wrap column is shown in the status bar (e.g. WRAP@79).

Word wrap is OFF by default. It is intended for writing prose; for source code or structured text, leave it off.

Note: word wrap inserts actual newlines into the document. It does not reflow existing paragraphs when you toggle it on.

FILE OPERATIONS

Ctrl+S Save.
If the document has not been saved before, you will be
prompted for a filename. Press Esc to cancel.
If the document already has a name, it is saved silently.

Ctrl+O Open.
You will be prompted for a filename. If the file is not
found, a message is shown and the current document is left
unchanged. Press Esc to cancel.
If the current document has unsaved changes, you will be
asked whether to save first.

Ctrl+N New document.
Clears the editing area and starts a blank document.
If the current document has unsaved changes, you will be
asked whether to save first.
Ctrl+Q Quit BasicStar.
If the current document has unsaved changes, you will be
asked whether to save first.

When prompted to save before losing changes, the options are:

Y Save the document (you will be prompted for a name if needed),
then continue with the operation.
N Discard changes and continue without saving.
C Cancel - return to the document without doing anything.

QUICK REFERENCE

Navigation Arrows, Home, End, PgUp, PgDn

Select Shift + any arrow key

Copy Ctrl+C

Cut Ctrl+X

Paste Ctrl+V

Undo Ctrl+Z

Redo Ctrl+Y

Find Ctrl+F

Find Next Ctrl+G

Replace All Ctrl+R

Word Wrap Ctrl+W

Save Ctrl+S

Open Ctrl+O

New Ctrl+N

Quit Ctrl+Q

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END OF MANUAL

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